



INTERNAL SECURITY

MODULE - 18

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

CHALLENGES OF BORDER SECURITY



1 Borders are the visible symbols of a country's sovereignty, unity and integrity.

2 There are three distinct sets of borders at the international level:

- Land borders
- Maritime boundaries
- Airspace

3 The transgressor is always on the lookout for soft gaps on land, along the coast or if need be, from the air.

4 The 1995 Purulia incident demonstrated our vulnerability from the air. It is therefore necessary to adopt a holistic approach to border management.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-PAKISTAN BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES



The LoC and the AGPL have seen constant tensions with border skirmishes and firing between the armies, and border security forces constantly guarding boundaries of both the countries.

1

The India-Pakistan boundary is categorised under three different heads:

- **Radcliff line:** This is 2,308 km long stretches from Gujarat to parts of Jammu district in Jammu and Kashmir
- **Line of Control (LoC):** The term refers to the military control line between the Indian and Pakistani controlled parts of the former princely state of Jammu and Kashmir—a line which does not constitute a legally recognized international boundary, but serves as the de facto border.
- **Actual Ground Position Line (AGPL):** This is 110 km long and extends from NJ 9842 to Indira Col in the North.

LINE OF CONTROL AND AGPL



RADCLIFFE LINE



BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-PAKISTAN BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES



2

The Indo-Pakistan border has been vulnerable to constant infiltration by foreign terrorists and Pakistani infiltrants for a very long time. Its main problems include:

- Diversity of terrain
- Extremely porous border
- Villagers accomplice to terrorists
- Large scale hawala network
- Discordant political relationship
- Absence of regional economic integration also resulted in restricted movement of people and goods across the border

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-PAKISTAN BORDER

MARITIME ISSUES



The main concern between India and Pakistan is the dispute of Sir Creek. It is a 96 km stretch of estuary in the marshes of Rann of Kutch, opening into the Arabian Sea, which separates India's Gujarat and Pakistan's Sindh.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-PAKISTAN BORDER

MARITIME ISSUES



1 The disputed region of Sir Creek has very little strategic or military significance but the region is rich in fishing resources, considered to be one of the largest fishing ground in Asia.

2 The region is expected to be rich in hydrocarbon and shale gas with immense potential.

3 When boundary gets defined it would help in determining the maritime boundaries which will further decide the limits of EEZ and Continental shelf.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-PAKISTAN BORDER

MARITIME ISSUES

WHAT HAPPENED POST – 1965?



- 1 In 1965, a dispute in this region contributed to the full-fledged war between India and Pakistan.

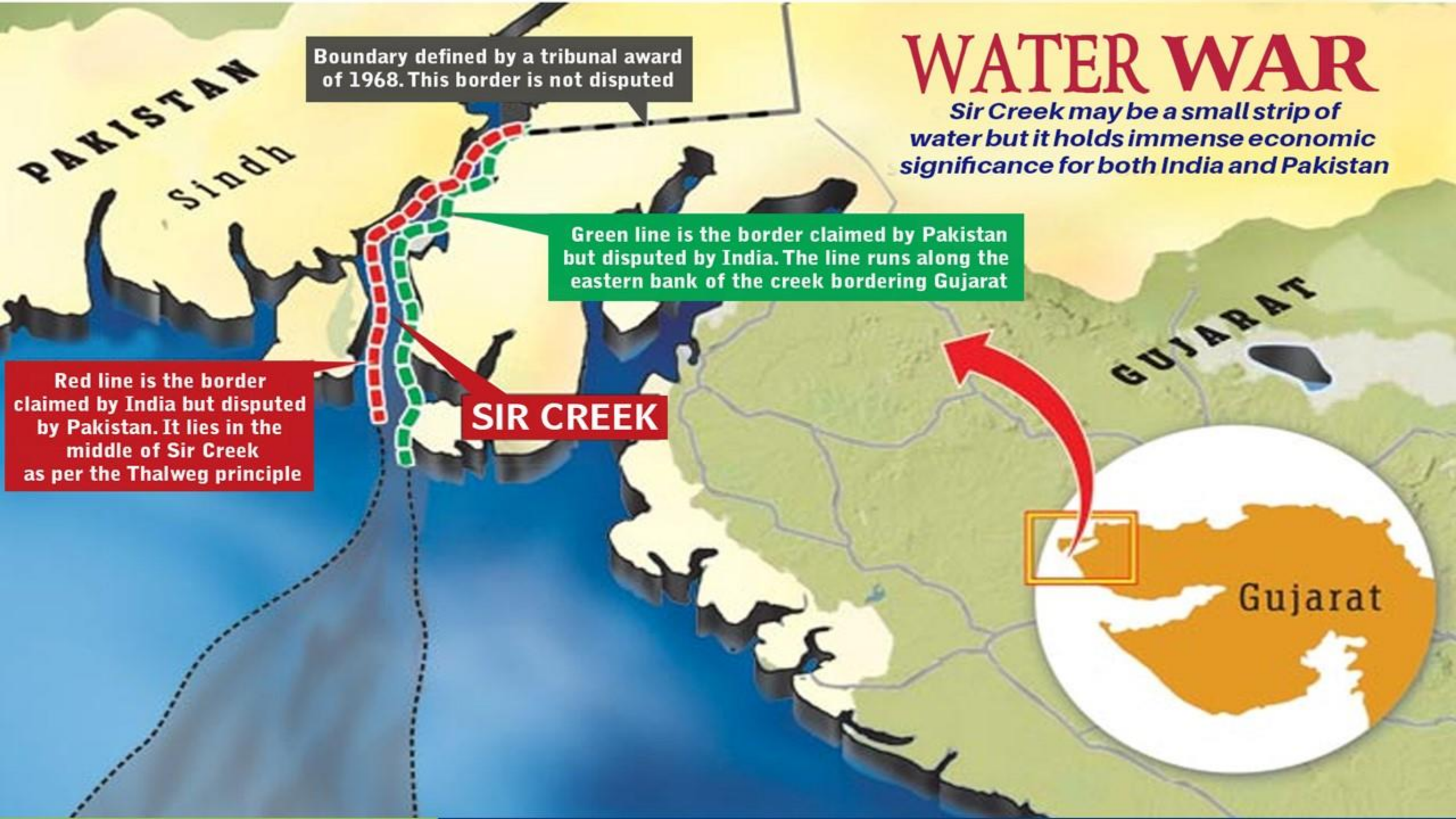
- 2 Later 'Indo-Pak western boundary case tribunal' was set up to resolve the dispute.

- 3 The tribunal upheld 90% of India's claim to the entire Rann leaving the boundary to the south unresolved.

- 4 Since 1969, there have been 8 rounds of 'composite dialogue group' held without any breakthrough.

WATER WAR

Sir Creek may be a small strip of water but it holds immense economic significance for both India and Pakistan



Boundary defined by a tribunal award of 1968. This border is not disputed

Green line is the border claimed by Pakistan but disputed by India. The line runs along the eastern bank of the creek bordering Gujarat

Red line is the border claimed by India but disputed by Pakistan. It lies in the middle of Sir Creek as per the Thalweg principle

SIR CREEK

GUJARAT

Gujarat

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-PAKISTAN BORDER

MARITIME ISSUES

WHAT HAPPENED POST – 1965?



5 Since neither side has concealed any ground, India has proposed for the demarcation of maritime border first as per the provisions of 'Technical Aspects of Laws of Sea' (TALOS).

6 However, Pakistan first wants the dispute to be resolved, taking it for international arbitration, which India has flatly denied citing it a purely bilateral issue.

With both the countries unable to agree on the exact boundary, the differences flow into the Arabian Sea creating a vast stretch of disputed waters, where fishermen's misery, terrorist's design and global drug syndicates' interests are all converging.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-CHINA BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES



- The border between India and China is not clearly demarcated throughout.
- India, following Independence, believed it had inherited firm boundaries from the British, but this was contrary to China's view.
- China felt the British had left behind a disputed legacy on the boundary between the two newly formed republics.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-CHINA BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES

1 Western Sector:

- India - Johnson line 
- Mc Donald line 
- The Johnson's line (proposed in 1865) shows Aksai Chin in Jammu and Kashmir under India's control whereas McDonald Line (proposed in 1893) places it under China's control.

2 Middle Sector:

- Not much dispute.
- In this sector, India shares about 625 km long boundary with China which runs along the watershed from Ladakh to Nepal.
- The states of Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand touch this border with Tibet (China) in this sector.
- Both sides do not have much disagreement over border in this area.

3 Eastern Sector:

- India – Mc Mahon Line
- China finds this unacceptable
- The region under dispute was formerly called as NEFA and is now called Arunachal Pradesh
- The Mc Mahon Line which was signed between Tibet and British India was unacceptable to China.



Western sector

- With 2,150 kms of border, the two sides differ over boundary line that separates erstwhile state of J&K from Xinjiang Province of China
- India accuses China of illegally occupying Aksai Chin
- The 1962 war saw fierce fighting between the two sides in this region.

Middle sector

- The 625 kms in this sector is the least controversial of the three.

Eastern sector

- The 1,140 km long boundary is contentious and is historically referred to as the McMahon Line, which Chinese do not accept because it was agreed to by the Tibetan representatives
- China claims the whole of Arunachal Pradesh around 85,000 sq.km as its territory.
- The two sides fought fiercely in this sector in 1962 but a better prepared China had the advantage.

CHINA

Sikkim

DOKLAM
TRI-JUNCTION

- This was the region where the 2017 stand-off took place in the tri-junction of India-China-Bhutan

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-CHINA BORDER



LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES

DAULAT BEG OLDI INCIDENT OF 2013



1 In 2013, Chinese troops had established a camp near Daulat Beg Oldi, close to the Aksai Chin-Ladakh Line of Actual Control (LAC).

2 Soldiers from both countries briefly set up camps on the ill-defined frontier facing each other.

3 It lies at the easternmost point of the Karakoram Range in a cold desert region, just 8 km south of the Chinese border and 9 km northwest of the Aksai Chin Line of Actual Control b/w China and India.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-CHINA BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES

DOKLAM MILITARY STANDOFF OF 2017



- 1** In June, a military standoff occurred between India and China in the disputed territory of Doklam, near the Doka La pass.
- 2** On June 16, 2017, the Chinese brought heavy road building equipment to the Doklam region and began constructing a road in the disputed area.
- 3** They would conduct foot patrol from this point up till the Royal Bhutanese Army (RBA) post at Jampheri Ridge.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-CHINA BORDER



LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES

DOKLAM MILITARY STANDOFF OF 2017



- 4** Both countries upped the ante and deployed around 3,000 troops each in the tri-junction.
- 5** The Doklam area has huge strategic significance for both India and China.
- 6** It lies in close proximity to sensitive Chicken's Neck, or the Siliguri Corridor, which connects the north-eastern region to the rest of India.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-CHINA BORDER

MARITIME ISSUES

- 1** In the context of security challenges from China to India, the maritime dimension is a relatively new factor.
- 2** The rapid growth of both the economies led to increased demand of energy and raw materials, which are transported by sea.
- 3** Both the economies are focusing on the sea lanes for the uninterrupted transportation of their trades and energy supply.

- 4** Thus, the Chinese PLA Navy is showing new found interest in the South China Sea, Strait of Malacca and all the way upto Strait of Hormuz.



This in fact has made her to formulate String of Pearls policy in which she seems to encircle and constrict India!

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-CHINA BORDER

MARITIME ISSUES

STRING OF PEARLS

- 1 It is a geopolitical theory on potential Chinese intentions in the Indian ocean region.
- 2 It refers to the network of Chinese military and commercial facilities and relationships along its sea lines of communication, which extend from the Chinese mainland to Port Sudan.
- 3 The sea lines of communication extend from the Chinese mainland to Port Sudan.
- 4 The sea lines run through several major maritime chokepoints such as the Strait of Bab-el-Mandeb, the Strait of Malacca, the Strait of Hormuz and the Lombok Strait as well as other strategic maritime centres in Pakistan, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, Maldives, and Somalia.
- 5 The term as a geopolitical concept was first used in an internal US Department of Defence report, "Energy Futures in Asia".

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-CHINA BORDER

MARITIME ISSUES

STRING OF PEARLS



6 The emergence of the String of Pearls is indicative of China's growing geopolitical influence through concerted efforts to increase access to ports and airfields, expand and modernise military forces, and foster stronger diplomatic relationships with trading partners.

7 The Chinese Government insists that China's burgeoning naval strategy is entirely peaceful in nature and is only for the protection of regional trade interests.

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-NEPAL BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES



Sashastra Seema Bal
Ministry of Home Affairs

- India-Nepal Treaty of Peace and Friendship
- Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB)
- Turbulent Himalayan rivers
- Destruction and removal of border pillars; encroachment into no-man's land by people from either side
- Allegations of excesses, such as intimidation and forcible grabbing of land by either side along the disputed border.
- The open borders have been exploited by terrorist organisation by insurgent groups like ULFA, NDBF and terrorist organisations like ISI, LeT

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-MYANMAR BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES

Though the boundary is properly demarcated under the 1967 agreement between both the countries, there are a few disputed pockets.



- Rugged terrain
- Clan loyalties and inter-tribal clashes
- Nagas, Kukis, Chin etc. support the insurgents in finding safe haven in Myanmar.
- Presence of golden triangle
- Smuggling of red sanders
- Amphetamine Type Stimulant, grocery items bicycle parts
- Free Movement Regime where tribals are allowed to travel 16kms across the border without any passport or visa.
- FICN, drug and human trafficking

BORDER AREA MANAGEMENT

INDO-BHUTAN BORDER

LAND BOUNDARY ISSUES



- 1 The Treaty of Peace between Britain and Bhutan demarcated the border in 1865, following the Bhutan War.

- 2 The boundary is demarcated except along the tri-junction with China, where the boundary is open.
- 3 The border was peaceful till Indian insurgent groups such as KLO, ULFA and NDBF established camps in the southern districts of Bhutan though these were flushed out later.
- 4 Smuggling and trafficking are also rampant along the border. Chinese made goods, Bhutanese cannabis, liquor and forest products are major items smuggled into India. Livestock, grocery items and fruits are smuggled to Bhutan.

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